

story_agent

Story Agent

Weekly AI-generated illustrated children's stories for ages 8–15

Overview

The Story Agent generates 4000–5500 word illustrated children's stories across 7 literary genres. It selects a random premise, writes a full narrative with chapter structure and dialogue, generates watercolour-style illustrations, and saves the story as 'pending' for admin approval. Unlike the Post Agent it does NOT use LangGraph — it is a simple sequential function pipeline called directly from main.py.

Invocation & Human-in-the-Loop Flow

Phase 1 — Generate	python -m meridian_agents.story_agent → runs pipeline, saves as PENDING
Phase 2 — Approve	python -m meridian_agents.story_agent approve
Phase 2 — Reject	python -m meridian_agents.story_agent reject
List pending	python -m meridian_agents.story_agent pending
Pending registry	story_agent/pending_stories.jsonl
Cron example	python -m meridian_agents.story_agent schedule '0 6 * * 1' (Monday 06:00 UTC)
Primary LLM	gemini-2.5-flash (shared llm.chat_completion())
Fallback LLM	gpt-4o (OPENAI_API_KEY)
Image models	Same provider chain as Post Agent: Imagen 4 → FLUX.1-dev → FLUX.1-schnell → Unsplash

Sequential Pipeline Steps

Step	Description
pick_theme_node(state)	Randomly selects a genre and one of 5 premises per genre. STORY_GENRE env var forces a specific genre.
write_story_node(state)	chat_completion() with _SYSTEM_PROMPT targeting 4000–5500 words. Returns JSON: title, excerpt, featuredImagePrompt, moralLesson, HTML content with [[IMAGE:...]] placeholders.

Step	Description
expand_story_node(state)	Conditional: called only if word_count < 4000. Passes current draft back to LLM with instruction to expand dialogue, scenes, and climax.
generate_story_images_node(state)	Generates cover image (1792×1024) and resolves all [[IMAGE:...]] placeholders with watercolour-style illustrations. Reuses post_agent image pipeline with _STYLE_PREFIX.
save_pending_node(state)	POST /api/stories with status='pending', genre, ageGroup='8-15', moralLesson. Uses make_agent_jwt() for authentication.

Story Genres & Premises

Genre	Moral Theme & Sample Premises
Adventure	Courage and acting despite fear — 5 premises (jungle map, cave portal, storm sailor...)
Fantasy	Kindness, curiosity, being yourself — 5 premises (wizard riddles, dragon, magical library...)
Mystery	Truth surfaces for honest seekers — 5 premises (robot detective, vanishing project, mansion...)
Fable	Differences are strengths — 5 premises (crow+eagle, ant+lion, elephant's ears...)
Science Fiction	Technology guided by empathy — 5 premises (AI friend, kid ambassador, time machine...)
Historical Fiction	Ordinary people do extraordinary things — 5 premises (Egypt, medieval Japan, Victorian...)
Mythology	Wisdom over power — 5 premises (Anansi, Viking girl, Greek oracle, Aztec boy...)

Illustration Style

All story images use the _STYLE_PREFIX: 'Children's book watercolour illustration, warm and vibrant colours, friendly and whimsical style, safe for all ages, detailed storybook art'. 6–8 [[IMAGE:...]] placeholders are placed by the LLM at key dramatic moments. Each becomes a with rounded corners and indigo caption.

Content Specifications

Minimum word count	4,000 words (expand node triggered if below)
Target word count	4,500–5,500 words (20-minute read)
Chapter structure	3–6 named chapters or clear sections

Age group	8–15 years
HTML tags allowed	<h2> <h3> <p> <blockquote>
Image placeholders	6–8 per story in [[IMAGE: description]] format
Tone	Warm, engaging, respects reader's intelligence — no graphic violence or adult themes

Key Files

File	Purpose
story_agent/main.py	Entry point: run_agent(), approve_story(), reject_story(), list_pending()
story_agent/state.py	StoryAgentState TypedDict
story_agent/nodes/writer.py	pick_theme_node, write_story_node, expand_story_node; all 7 genre definitions
story_agent/nodes/images.py	generate_story_images_node; watercolour style prefix; reuses post_agent image utils
story_agent/nodes/publisher.py	save_pending_node; POST /api/stories
story_agent/tracer.py	AgentRun lifecycle tracking
meridian_agents/llm.py	Shared chat_completion() — Gemini primary / gpt-4o fallback